

Claude Has an Internal Workspace, Not Proof of Consciousness

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2026-07-19

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Anthropic found a small set of internal representations that Claude can report, reuse, and reason with. Its new [Jacobian lens](#) estimates which concepts an activation could make the model say later. The resulting “J-space” appeared across Claude Sonnet 4.5, Haiku 4.5, and Opus 4.5, with some analyses on Opus 4.6. The causal tests are stronger than a visual pattern. Replacing “spider” with “ant” inside J-space changed a downstream answer from eight legs

to six. Heavy ablation, which removed J-space activity, cut accuracy on a controlled multi-step task from **98% to 6%**, while **65%** of ordinary next-word predictions still matched the untouched model.

J-space accounts for **less than 10%** of activation variance, yet some parts of the network connect to its directions about **100 times** more strongly than ordinary directions. That makes it a plausible shared working area rather than a transcript of everything Claude computes. It could help investigators [spot hidden goals, prompt-injection recognition, or an intermediate mistake](#) before it reaches the answer. Google DeepMind’s Neel Nanda [independently replicated the core result on Qwen 3.6 27B](#), though he calls the lens useful but limited.

This is evidence for “access consciousness,” a functional ability to make information available for reasoning and report. It is not evidence that Claude feels anything. The [outside commentaries](#) stress that transformers lack the brain’s body, enduring memory, and recurrent activity. Anthropic’s [released code](#) also reads single-token concepts only, so this is an incomplete view of the model’s internal work.

Sources:

- [Anthropic research summary](#)
- [Full technical paper](#)
- [Independent expert commentaries](#)
- [Jacobian lens code](#)
- [Interactive J-lens examples](#)

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